



Shelf Tagging Guide: "Farm to Aisle" (Canadian-Origin Labels)

Team NavySilver

Yue Wang - Product Owner

Faiza Haque - Product Owner

Nikki McDonald - Scrum Master

Carly Orth - Scrum Master





Business Overview

Loblaw Companies Limited (L.TO) is a major Canadian retailer offering grocery, pharmacy, healthcare services, health & beauty, apparel, general merchandise, financial services, and wireless products.

Core Problem

Customers want transparent, reliable information about where products are made, especially Canadian-made items, but current packaging often creates confusion rather than clarity.

The World of Loblaw Companies Limited

Loblaw®

C O M P A N I E S L I M I T E D





Our Inspiration

- Canadians wanting Canadian-made and prepared products
- Customers wanting **transparent, trustworthy** communication about where products are from
- Loblaws' current "Made in Canada" and "Prepared in Canada" labels are **ambiguous**

The **lack of clarity** impacts:

- Employees
- Customers
- Canadian producers
- Loblaws' as a brand



Loblaws Companies Limited, n.d.

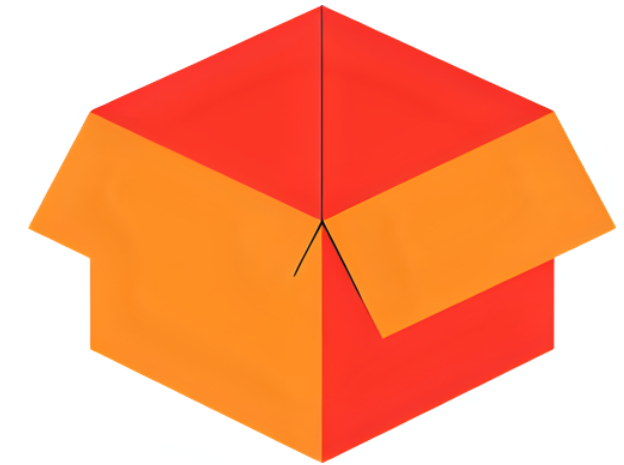
The issue **motivated** our team to explore solutions that rebuild trust through clear, accessible in-store communication.



How Might We

How might we design a physical shelf-level display that helps shoppers trust and recognize Canadian-made products?





PRODUCT BACKLOG

1. Shelf-level Tag Design

User Story: As a Canadian shopper, I want to easily see where a product was made so I can support local producers/farmers.

Deliverable: Design and prototype shelf tags that clearly identify “Made in Canada” and “Prepared in Canada” products by color coding tags with bilingual text and recognizable icons.

2. Educational Supporting Signage

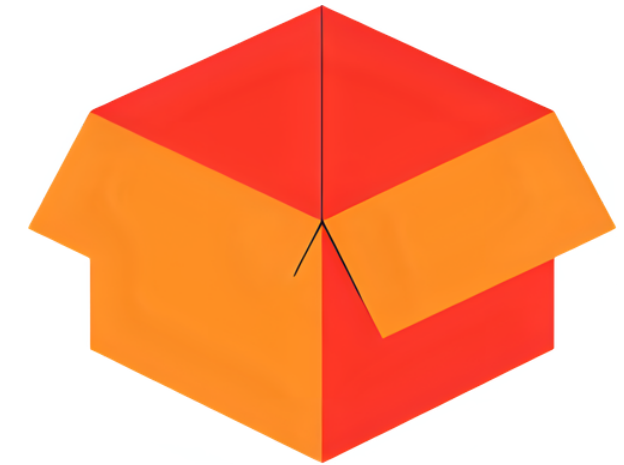
User Story: As a Canadian shopper, I want to access a product’s information in-store to learn how and where it was prepared so I can feel confident in its origin.

Deliverable: Create large and small posters that can be placed on shelves, aisles, and walls explaining the meaning of each color.

3. Quick Recognition Test

User Story: As a busy shopper, I want to quickly identify Canadian-made products so I can spend less time deciding between products.

Deliverable: Prototype shelf tags that are highly visible from a distance (~1 meter away from shelf) and conduct a brief user test to ensure shoppers can identify tags in less than 5 seconds.



PRODUCT BACKLOG

4. Accessibility Enhancements

User Story: As a shopper with low vision, I want tactile and easy to understand shelf cues so that I can easily access origin details and shop comfortably.

Deliverable: Add tactile/raised design features such as an embossed icon and ensure high-contrast colors for readability.

5. Employee Tagging

User Story: As a store employee, I want to clearly tag and display Canadian-made products so that shoppers can easily identify them without needing my help.

Deliverable: Create ~1 page guide for employees instructing them how to add and replace tags to the shelves.

6. Feedback Summary

User Story: As a store manager, I want to know which products shoppers interact with the most so I can optimize placement and promotions for Canadian-made products.

Deliverable: Conduct observational testing and consolidate usability and visibility feedback with a feedback summary.



USER STORIES

As a **Canadian shopper**, I want to easily see where a product was made in Canada so that I can support local producers/farmers.

As a **Canadian shopper**, I want to access a product's information in-store to learn how and where it was prepared so that I feel confident in its origin.

As a **shopper with low vision**, I want tactile and easy to understand shelf cues so that I can easily access origin details and shop comfortably.

As a **busy shopper**, I want to quickly identify Canadian-made products so that I can spend less time deciding between products.

As a **store employee**, I want to clearly tag and display Canadian-made products so that shoppers can easily identify them without needing my help.

As a **store manager**, I want to know which products shoppers interact with most so that I can optimize placement and promotions for Canadian-made items.



SPRINT BACKLOG

1. Review and take note of existing labeling and in-store displays.
2. Define existing imagery or symbols/visual cues that represent Canadian branding (i.e. colors, maple leaf icons)
3. Sketch rough low-fidelity concepts of what the shelf-level display could look like.
4. Design and craft a 3D prototype imitating how the display would look/fit on a shelf of products.
5. Consider simple accessibility features that could be incorporated into the prototype.
6. Test with family members/friends or consult with AI to conduct user testing.
7. Consider testing results to finalize the features of the display.
8. Finalize the low-fidelity prototype and summarize findings.



ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

User Story	Acceptance Criteria
Canadian shopper — see origin easily	Product origin must be clearly visible on product detail page, origin label must be readable at a glance
Canadian shopper — access info in-store	Tags/QR codes must link to accurate origin & preparation info, Info must load quickly and be easy to understand
Busy shopper — quick identification	Canadian-made products must have a distinct, instantly recognizable visual cue on shelves, Cue must work even among crowded displays
Shopper with low vision — tactile cues	Tactile or high-contrast tags/icons must indicate origin, Braille or raised elements must be easy to locate by touch.
Store employee — clear tagging process	Tagging steps must be simple, intuitive, and prevent user error, Employees must be able to confirm correct placement
Store manager — track engagement	System must track shopper interaction data accurately, Manager dashboard must display top-interacted Canadian-made products.



SPRINT 1 DELIVERABLES

Delivery One

Provided final copy of user stories to the Development Team

Delivery Two

Communicated with the Development team as they completed the first designs based on the user stories provided



SPRINT 1 FEEDBACK

WHAT WE LIKED:

- Great user testing on completed deliverables
- Options 1B, 2B, & 2C for **large poster**
- Option 2 for **small poster**
- Option A2, A3, & B3 for **tag design**
- Employee handbook: thoughtful addition to the deliverables

Areas of Improvement:

- Clarity of meaning without needing explanation
- Comprehension through posters, maybe going a step further in educating shoppers
- Conduct brief tests, see which colour/icon means after 3 seconds to a new user
- Clarity of materials in the handbook
- Feedback loop, how do employees know if their work meets standard





SPRINT 2 DELIVERABLES



Large poster



Small poster

User Test Questions

Instruction:

Show the user the educational poster for 3 seconds

Questions:

1. What does the **red colour** mean?
2. What does the **blue colour** mean?
3. What is the **icon** for **Made in Canada**?
4. What is the **icon** for **Prepared in Canada**?
5. Was the poster **clear and easy to understand**? Why or why not?
6. Will you be **looking for these colours and symbols in store**? Why or Why not?

option B3



Prepared in Canada tag

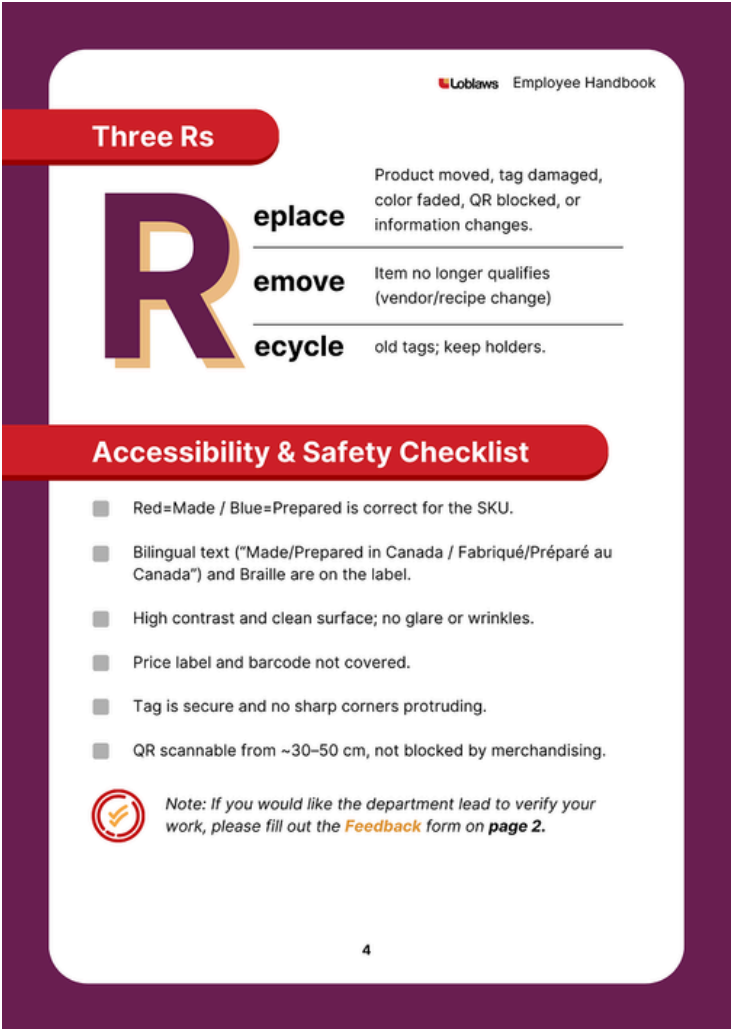
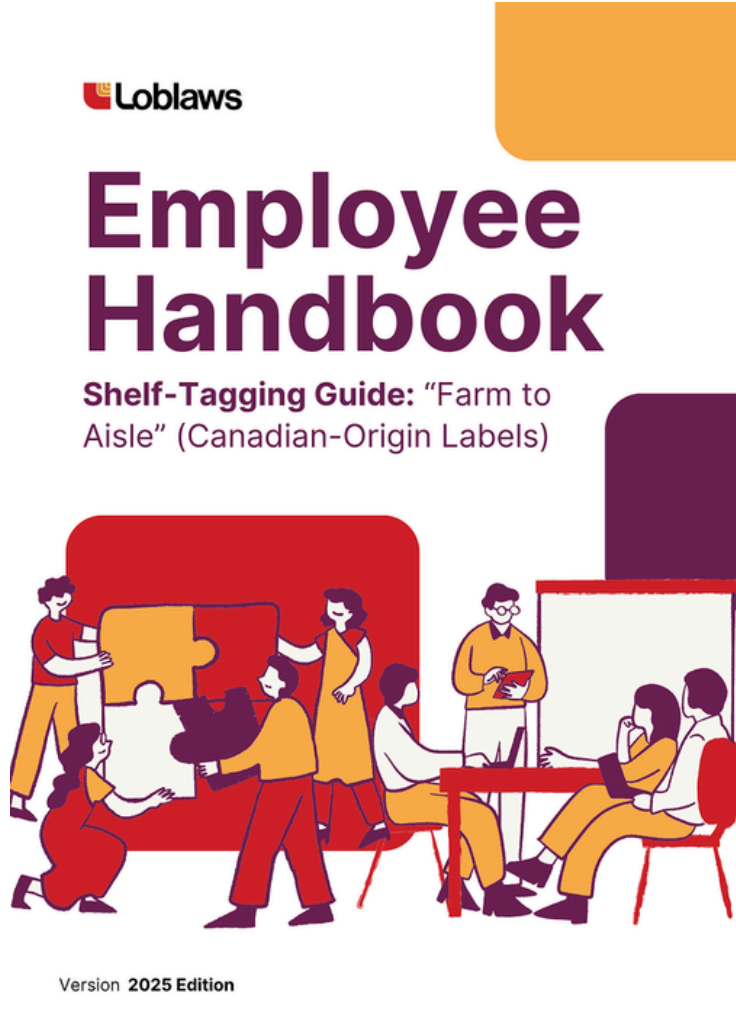
option A3



Made in Canada tag



SPRINT 2 DELIVERABLES



Employee handbook pages



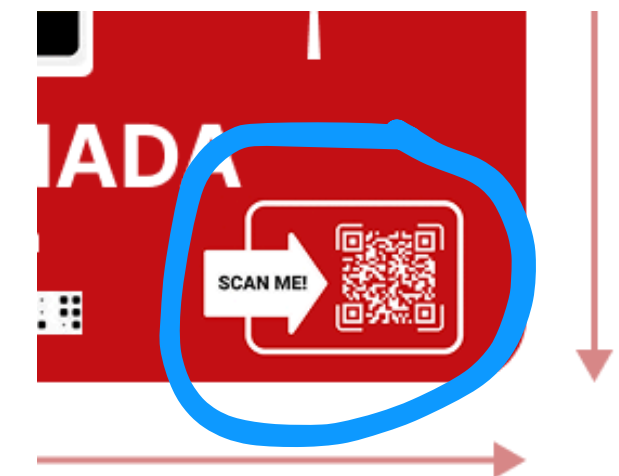
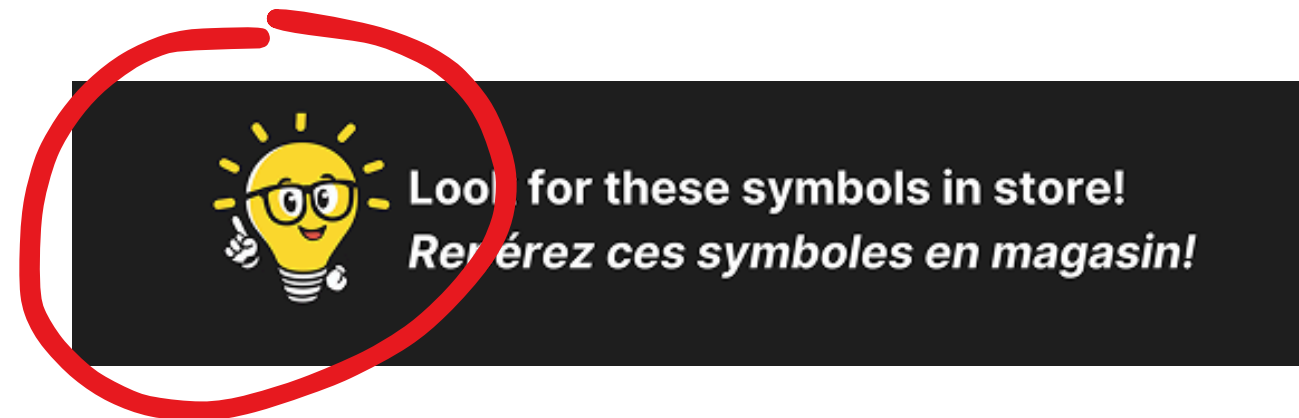
SPRINT 2 FEEDBACK

WHAT WE LIKED:

- **Large poster's** visual legend and the addition of the lightbulb character to make it more eye-catching
- Placing the QR code higher on the **smaller poster** better aligned its importance with the hierarchy of information on the small poster
- QR code on **tag A3**, as well as the contrasting tag colours with different meanings
- Adding a feedback QR code to the **employee handbook** was smart

NEXT STEPS:

- Development team debated removing the QR code from the large poster - a suggestion was to keep it as an attention-grabber/something to incentivize people to pause and scan for more info, but move it to the bottom for reduced hierarchy importance, and play with size
- Test signage as a complete system
- Make it clear where user feedback goes in the employee handbook





SPRINT 3 DELIVERABLES

Option 1



Large Poster



Option 2



Small Poster



Made in Canada tag



Made in Canada tag

SPRINT 3 DELIVERABLES

Quick Tagging Reference

Color & Icon

Red + Maple Leaf =
Made in Canada



Blue + Chef =
Prepared in Canada



Install Tag: 5 Steps

1. Confirm eligibility.*
2. Select correct tag; remove current ticket(s).
3. Layer origin tag behind the price ticket.
4. Insert bottom edge into lower groove.
5. Snap top to secure; center under product.

* If unclear, see Questions & Feedback section for instructions.

Quick Check

- ✓ Price + barcode visible; nothing covered
- ✓ Holder fully seated (top lip tucked, bottom edge locked)
- ✓ One tag per SKU; consistent alignment

Quick Tagging Reference

Common Mistakes → Quick Fix

- ✗ Covers price/ESL or barcode → re-center with 3–5 mm clearance.
- ✗ Loose/tilted or duplicate → reseal or remove extra.
- ✗ Never place on product/outside rail.

Accessibility & Safety

- Correct color; bilingual text and Braille present.
- Clean, high contrast; no sharp corners.
- QR scannable ~30–50 cm; not blocked.

Where to Find Materials

- (1) Pre-printed red/blue tags + (2) small basket are **at the employee station**; the full employee handbook is available there as well.

Questions & Feedback

- If uncertain, **do not tag**; capture SKU/photo; **escalate via QR form to the lead**.
- Same QR for handbook feedback or questions; paper copy at the employee station.



FRONT

BACK

Quick Reference Card for Employees on the Floor

- Card delivers fast, reliable, device-free guidance on the floor with consistent standards
- Physical print → more reliable, as many Floor Managers restrict phone use during shift



SPRINT 3 FEEDBACK

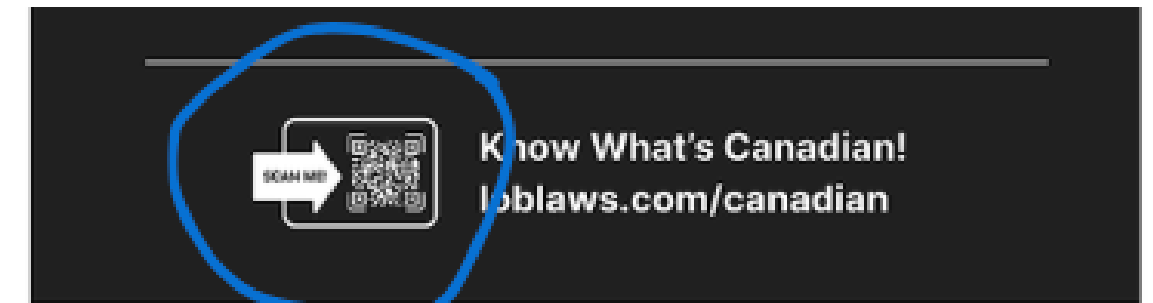
WHAT WE LIKED:

- **Posters & Tags:**
 - Large poster: hierarchy effective with QR code
 - Small poster: Option 1 preferred for label consistency
 - Tag A4: balances French/English text, Braille accessible
 - Tag B4: clear, simple, and integrates price.
- **Employee Handbook:** Feedback info updated, questions condensed, **quick reference card improves usability.**

NEXT STEPS:

- Finalize layouts, tag/poster adjustments, and handbook updates.
- Prepare final deliverables: slide deck, iterations, and user test summary.

Fièrement fabriqué au Canada



Option 1





SPRINT 3 USER TESTING

User Test Questions

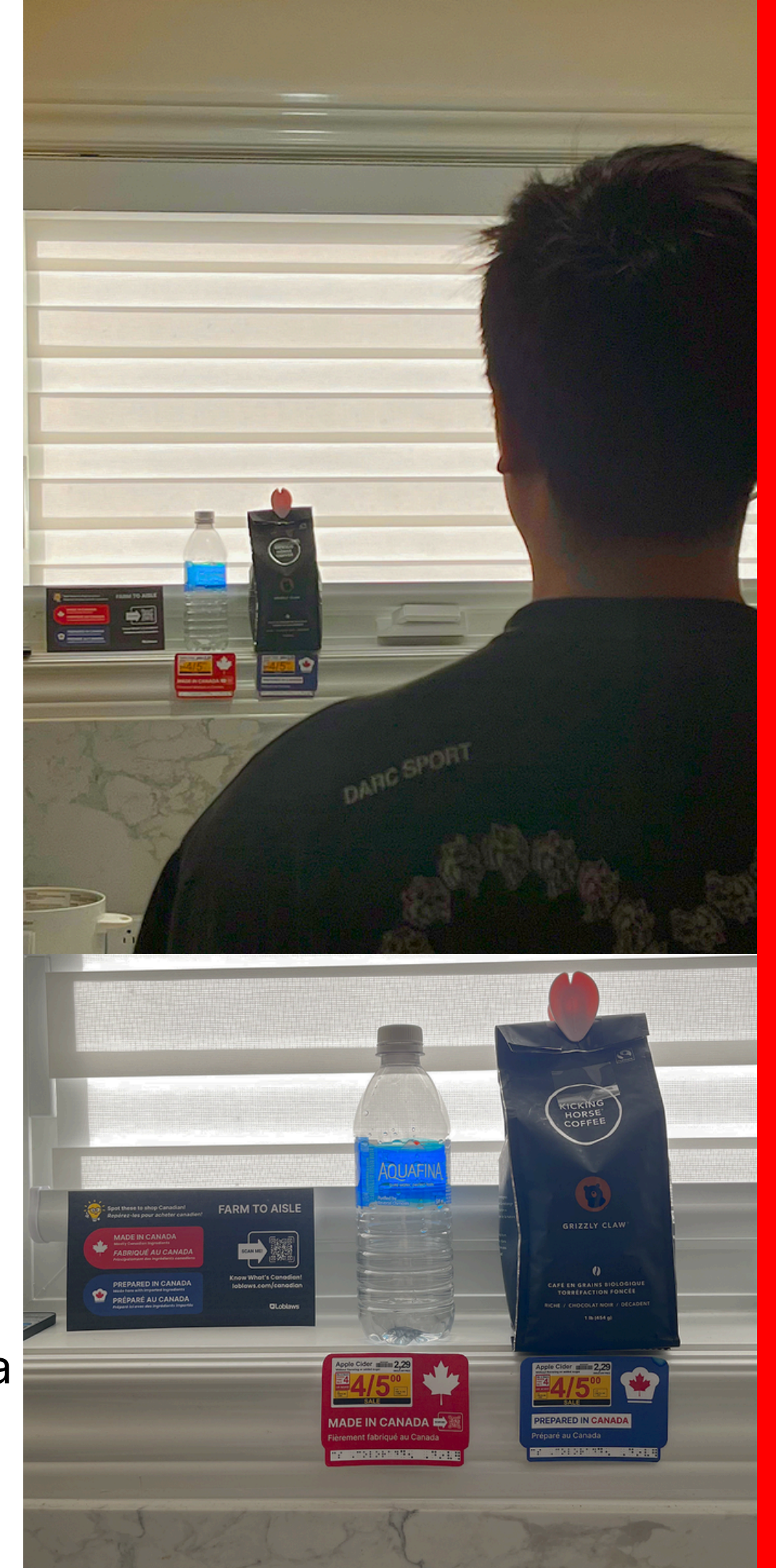
Instructions:

DIGITAL: First, show participants the Large Poster (4:5 or 36" × 45"). Let them know it's designed for high-traffic or entrance areas to attract attention from a distance.

PHYSICAL: Then, show the Small Poster and the Tag together.

Questions:

- What does the **red colour** mean?
- What does the **blue colour** mean?
- Which icon **represents** Made in Canada?
- Which icon **represents** Prepared in Canada?
- Was the poster **clear and easy to understand**? Why or why not?
- Would you look for **these colours and symbols** in store? Why or why not?
- Does the large poster **make you interested** in learning more about Canadian products?
- Does the small poster **clearly explain the difference between** Prepared in Canada and Made in Canada?
- Are you **inclined to learn more** by visiting the website or scanning the QR code?





SPRINT 4 FINAL DELIVERABLES

 Look for these symbols in store!
Repérez ces symboles en magasin!

 **MADE IN CANADA**
Mostly Canadian Ingredients
FABRIQUÉ AU CANADA
Principalement des ingrédients canadiens

 **PREPARED IN CANADA**
Made here with imported ingredients
PRÉPARÉ AU CANADA
Préparé ici avec des ingrédients importés

FARM TO AISLE 

 Know What's Canadian!
loblaws.com/canadian

Large poster



Tags

Quick Reference Card for Employees on the Floor

Small poster

 Spot these to shop Canadian!
Repérez-les pour acheter canadien!

FARM TO AISLE

 **MADE IN CANADA**
Mostly Canadian Ingredients
FABRIQUÉ AU CANADA
Principalement des ingrédients canadiens

 **PREPARED IN CANADA**
Made here with imported ingredients
PRÉPARÉ AU CANADA
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Where to Find Materials

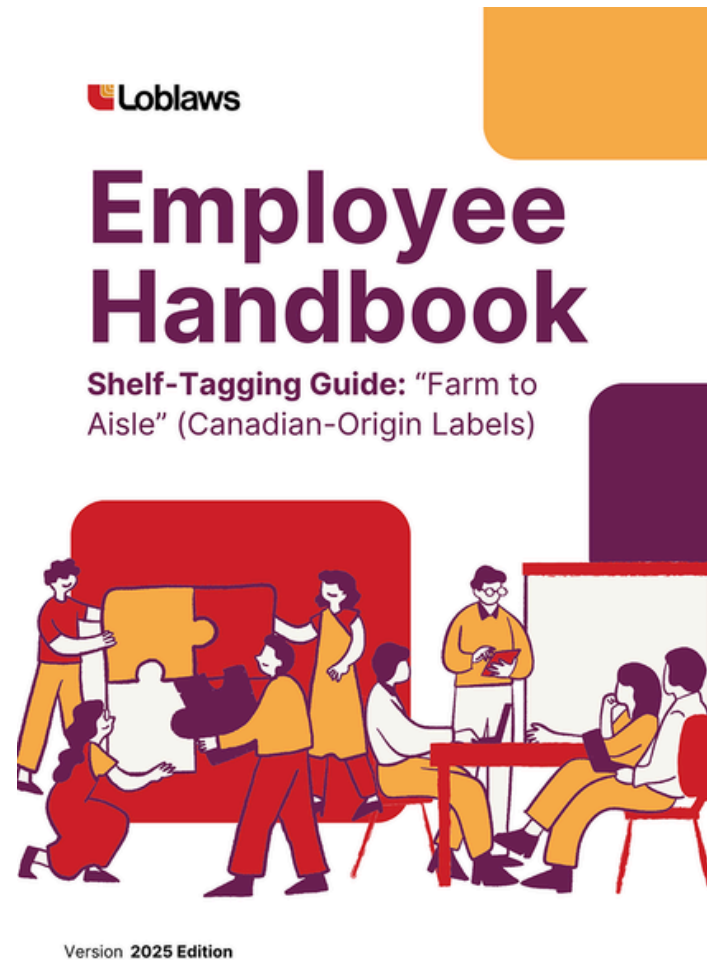
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Questions & Feedback

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SPRINT 4 FINAL DELIVERABLES



Full employee handbook



Digital version for page 3
(clickable link to feedback
survey instead of a QR code)





TEAM CHARTER REFLECTION

How it Supported us

- Helped us keep track of tasks, roles, and responsibilities
- Encouraged consistent communication and weekly check-ins
- Set clear behavioural expectations and strengthened accountability
- Provided a visual overview of the project scope and kept us aligned with deliverables
- Guided Product Owners in maintaining the product backlog and criteria for sprint work

What we Learned

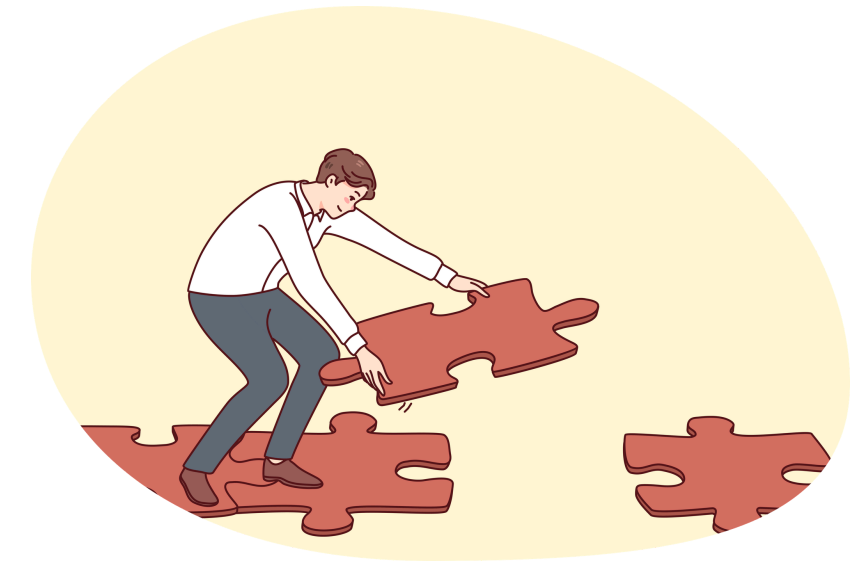
- Helped identify team strengths and weaknesses, keeping us mindful of expectations
- Supported our progress by showing where we were in the process and what was coming next
- Contributed to the successful organization and execution of all Sprints

Challenges we Noticed

- Limited expertise in assigned roles made it difficult to fully apply some parts of the charter
- Relying only on the charter sometimes felt restrictive when we lacked full role understanding



CHALLENGES



WHAT WORKED WELL



- Despite the lack of meetings we were able to have, both teams strived to keep consistent communication via Teams
- We learned how to adapt to our roles and were satisfied with the direction of our HMW statement and the final deliverables

WHAT DIDN'T WORK WELL



- Our project management team initially ran into struggles with developing our HMW statement and making it understandable for the development team
- There was confusion in the beginning of the project with roles, responsibilities, and expectations being mixed up



SCRUM MEETINGS



WHAT WORKED WELL



- Meetings helped the development team to clarify feedback and expectations for the next sprint
- Project managers had a chance to discuss specific things more clearly that they may have not been able to through text
- Helped to make sure everyone was on the same page in

WHAT DIDN'T WORK WELL

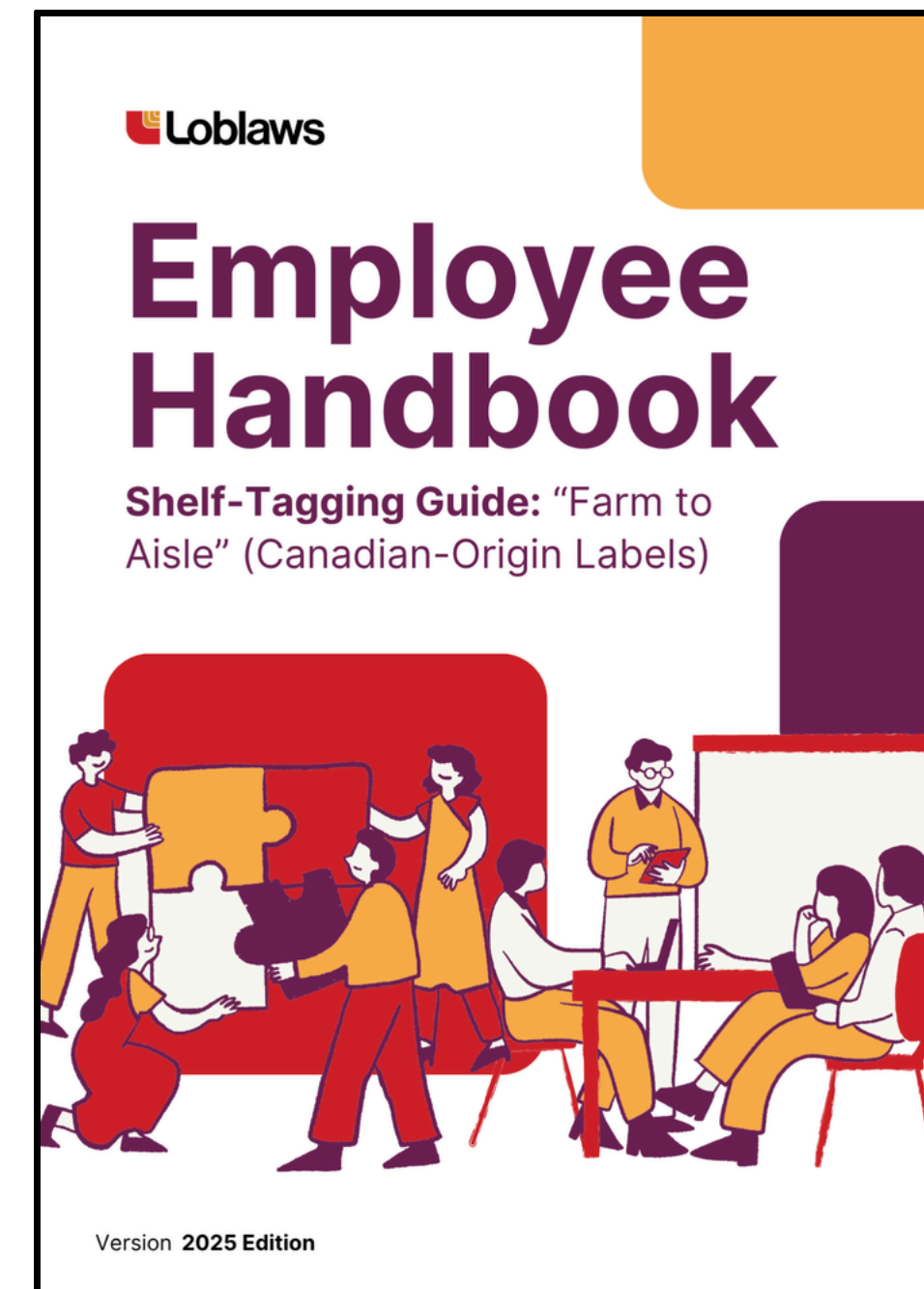


- Meetings without a clear agenda were often a bit awkward and difficult to start off. We should have drafted meeting agendas to help guide our discussions
- Finding common availabilities for a group of 7 members was very challenging
- No one on the scrum team had previous project management experience, so we all felt lost in how to run the meetings



SPRINT REVIEW

- Walk through user stories to show alignment with How Might We + acceptance criteria
- Connect each user story to final design features
- Show iteration: sketches → low-fidelity → final prototype
- Highlight improvements made through feedback
- Demo final increment: shelf-tag system + employee handbook
- Present in a store-like display to simulate real shelf complexity



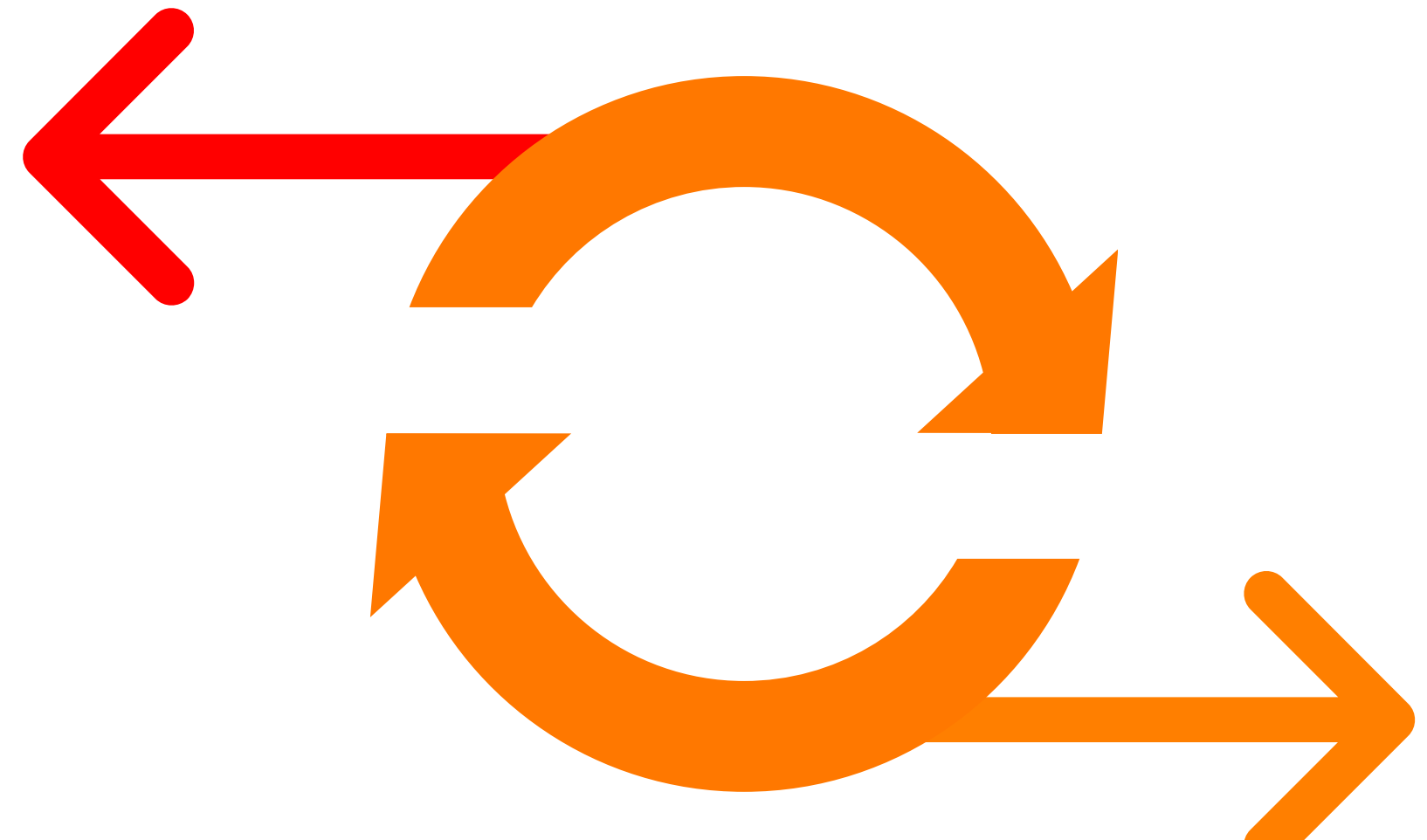


ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA & DEFINITION OF DONE

- Relied on our acceptance criteria and definition of done to give weekly feedback to the development team.
- At times was challenging to provide feedback without revisiting and double-checking the criteria we had set.
- Some product backlog items needed adjustment as situations changed.
- Example: When the team couldn't test prototypes on real store shelves, we revised the backlog to focus on testing printed prototypes in home environments instead.

What to Improve for the Future

- **Revisit** acceptance criteria more often to ensure they stay realistic and aligned with constraints.
- **Build** in flexibility for exploratory testing or unexpected limitations.
- **Provide** clearer guidance on how minor deviations from the definition of done should be handled.





KEY TAKEAWAYS



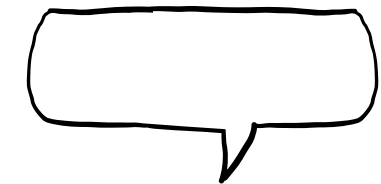
Staying Within Role Boundaries

- Clear separation between Product Owners and Scrum Masters
 - Product Owners: set vision + prioritize backlog
 - Scrum Masters: support team + remove obstacles
- **Impact:** improved efficiency, clarity, and teamwork



Importance of Timing in One-Week Sprints

- With quickly moving sprints, it was important to stay ahead
- Early feedback and preparation prevented last-minute pressure
- **Impact:** Maintained momentum and reduced stress for the Project Managers and the Development Team



Power of Effective Communication

- Communication between the Product Management team and the Development Team was key
- Strong communication led to smooth execution and a confident team
- Kept all members aligned with the team goal
- **Impact:** Ensured alignment and consistent progress



CONCLUSION

Valuable Agile Introduction

- Hands-on experience with agile project management

Refined Project Approach

- Strengthened HMW statement, improved user stories, and collaborated with the Development Team

Overcoming Challenges

- Adapted to early issues with meeting structure, role, clarity, and assumption testing

Importance of Team Structure

- Clear roles, communication, and processes guided us to success

Lessons we Learned

- Enhanced understanding of agile practices; highlighted organization, transparency, and responsiveness.



Thank You

